
MAC County Courier - June 12, 2026

From David Owen <dowen@mocounties.com>

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To Curt Warfield <cwarfield@callawaycounty.org>



The County Courier

June 12, 2026

Missouri News

Missouri school funding overhaul runs into a property assessment problem

Problems with how Missouri counties assess real estate are complicating an effort to update the formula that determines state aid for public schools.

In a meeting last week, the Missouri School Funding Modernization Task Force discussed how an updated formula could factor in local property taxes as real estate valuations struggle to keep up with inflation.

"Property values and property taxes have been used to fund schools, in part, because of the stability of it," said Kari Monsees, the state education department's former finance chief and task force facilitator. "Stability is an attribute for it, and now it has destabilized, at least in the short term." [Read more](#)



Missouri auditor warns deep budget cuts loom as surplus nears end

Missouri is about to exhaust the surplus lawmakers relied on to balance the state budget, and elected officials are going to have to make deep cuts to align spending with revenue, State Auditor Scott Fitzpatrick said in a report released Wednesday. [Read more](#)

Missouri higher education officials feel pressure to overhaul funding formula

The Missouri Department of Higher Education and Workforce Development has until Dec. 1 to craft a new formula for distributing state aid among public colleges and universities — or risk lawmakers creating their own plan that “institutions quite likely will not like,” the state’s higher education commissioner said Wednesday. [Read more](#)

Missouri courts keep rewriting ballot language as fights over direct democracy intensify

As Missouri secretary of state, Denny Hoskins is often responsible for reducing complicated ballot measures to a few sentences voters can understand. [Read more](#)

Missouri Supreme Court declines to hear appeal over Amendment 5 ballot summary

The Missouri Supreme Court refused Monday to hear a last-minute appeal filed by proponents of a measure to repeal the state income tax seeking to revise the summary voters will see on the Aug. 4 ballot. [Read more](#)

‘They’re already here’: Regulating data centers stalls in Missouri

The rapid expansion of hyperscale data centers is far outstripping efforts to regulate them in Missouri and other states. [Read more](#)

Missouri Realtors pour \$1.9 million into campaign to defeat Amendment 5 tax plan

The Missouri Association of Realtors donated \$1.9 million to the campaign opposing Amendment 5 on Tuesday, escalating the fight over a proposed constitutional amendment that would create a pathway for lawmakers to eliminate the state income tax through expanded or increased sales taxes. [Read more](#)

Missouri Realtors spend \$2 million to fight Amendment 4 limits on citizen initiative petitions

The Missouri Association of Realtors donated \$2 million Monday to defeat Amendment 4, pouring new money into a fight over citizen-led ballot initiatives just days after spending nearly the same amount to oppose a separate tax overhaul on Missouri’s Aug. 4 ballot. [Read more](#)

County News



Montgomery County approves a tax incentive package for Google data center

The Montgomery County Commission unanimously approved a tax incentive package Monday for Google's proposed \$15 billion data center, despite ongoing concerns from residents about how the huge data center could have negative effects on the county.

According to cost/benefit analysis documents, the deal is much bigger than the \$15 billion figure previously announced. Google could invest as much as \$87.5 billion in equipment over the life of the project, with an initial phase of roughly \$24.5 billion in equipment and \$13.4 billion in real property improvements between 2026 and 2029. [Read more](#)

Vandalized street signs in Jefferson County raise concerns for MoDOT

The Missouri Department of Transportation has seen an increase in vandalized road signs in Jefferson County that officials say pose “immediate and serious safety risks for all roadway users.” [Read more](#)

Franklin County silences public comment after heated meetings

Tension is rising in Franklin County after commissioners suspended public comment at their meetings, drawing criticism from residents and a fellow elected official. [Read more](#)

Data centers are toxic in KC politics. Here’s what MO lawmakers are – or aren’t – doing

Missouri lawmakers didn’t pass any new regulations on data centers this year, maintaining a status quo of local decisions that frequently draw protests from nearby residents. [Read more](#)

Area legislators field questions on schools, taxes in aftermath of legislative session

More than two dozen area residents came to Wright City City Hall Wednesday, June 3 to get the opportunity to ask questions of Missouri state Sen. Ben Brown and Rep. Jeff Myers following the end of the recent legislative session. [Read more](#)

Perry County moves forward with senior property tax relief program after voter approval

Perry County officials are continuing work to implement a new Senior Property Tax Relief Program after voters overwhelmingly approved the measure in April. [Read more](#)

Cole County sheriff proposes sales tax increase: 'We are at a tipping point'

The Cole County Sheriff's Department has proposed a temporary sales tax increase to fund an expansion to the county jail, support employee salaries and cover other expenses for the department. [Read more](#)

Share your county's achievements and honors

The Missouri Association of Counties would like you to Show Me Your County.

Show Me Your County is a chance for our counties to highlight a program, initiative or praise a hard-working county employee who has gone above and beyond their duties or has received an award.

Counties can submit a 500-word or less description of the program, initiative or employee, along with pictures if applicable. Those submissions will then be featured on MAC's social media platforms and in the Missouri County Record magazine.

SHOW ME
YOUR COUNTY

Submit your county today

June

June 17 - Missouri Data Center Summit in Jefferson City

June 19 - State offices closed/Juneteenth

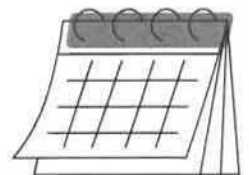
July

July 3 - State offices closed/Independence Day (observed)

July 14 - Last day for Governor to veto bills

July 17-20 - NACo Annual Conference

August



Aug. 4 - Official Election Day
Aug. 10-13 - Sheriffs' Summer Conference
Aug. 10-12 - MAC Summer Board Meeting
Aug. 28 - Bills become law
Aug. 31-Sept. 4 - Clerks' / Election Authorities' Annual Conference

Schedule of upcoming webinars for NACo members

NACo hosts several webinars for its members that cover a variety of different topics and programs for county government officials and their staff. Learn about the upcoming webinars and register to attend.



[View the webinars and register](#)

NACo Annual Conference in New Orleans, July 17-20

The NACo Annual Conference is the premier gathering of elected and appointed officials from the nation's 3,069 counties, parishes and boroughs. The conference will include dozens of committee and caucus meetings, educational workshops, general sessions and more. Sessions will offer learning and best practices on the full range of county responsibilities and domestic policy issues. NACo membership will also elect new leadership and set the organization's policy priorities during the Annual Business Meeting.

[Register today](#)

NACo member running for 2nd VP is offering Datacenter webinar

Mike Turner, Vice Chair of the Loudoun County, VA Board of Supervisors, who also serves as the Chair of both the National Association of Counties (NACo) and the Virginia Association of Counties (VACo) Environment and Energy Land Use Committees is offering a free 60-minute webinar titled, "County Lessons Learned from 'Data Center Alley,' Loudoun County, VA."

Webinars will be held every Monday at 3 p.m. CDT and Thursday at 2 p.m. CDT until June 30

[Register for the webinar](#)

Registration is now open for the 2026 NACo Energy Symposium

Join county leaders from across the country in the Texas Panhandle for the 2026 NACo Energy Symposium, presented by the Rural Action Caucus in partnership with the NACo Rural Energy Academy. Held Sept. 23-25, 2026, this event will offer county officials a unique opportunity to engage with the most pressing energy issues shaping county land use decisions today.

[Register now](#)

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Missouri Association of Counties

PO Box 234

Jefferson City, MO 65102-0234

United States

573-634-2120 | www.mocounties.com

Sent from: info@mocounties.com

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